

SS1 ENGLISH LANGUAGE DIAGNOSTIC (PART 1)

Standard: Cambridge IGCSE / O-Level Bridge

Scope: Grammar, Usage, and Advanced Lexis (Questions 1 - 30)

Section A: Advanced Grammar & Structure

Choose the most appropriate option to complete the sentences.

No.	Question & Options	Ans	Diagnostic Focus
1	Neither the Principal nor the teachers _____ present at the seminar yesterday. A) was B) were C) has been D) is	B	Subject-Verb Agreement (Proximity Rule).
2	Had I known the difficulty of the task, I _____ differently. A) will act B) would have acted C) would act D) had acted	B	Conditionals (Third Conditional/Regret).
3	The judge decided to _____ the case until further evidence was provided. A) adjourn B) abort C) adapt D) address	A	Registers: Legal/Formal Vocabulary.
4	The information he provided was so _____ that we couldn't make any sense of it. A) ambiguous B) articulate C) authentic D) audacious	A	Precision in Vocabulary.
5	Hardly _____ the room when the phone started ringing. A) he entered B) did he enter C) had he entered D) he had entered	C	Inversion for Emphasis.
6	I look forward to _____ you at the graduation ceremony next month. A) see B) seen C) seeing D) have seen	C	Gerunds after Phrasal Verbs.
7	The novel, _____ author won the Nobel Prize, has been adapted into a film. A) who B) which C) whose D) whom	C	Relative Pronouns (Possession).
8	If she _____ more time, she would take up painting as a hobby. A) has B) had C) has had D) will have	B	Second Conditional (Hypothetical).
9	The assembly was _____ because of the unexpected rainstorm. A) called off B) called in C) called out D) called up	A	Phrasal Verbs (Cambridge/Nigerian integration).
10	Choose the correctly punctuated sentence: A) The students' books were left in the classroom. B) The students books were left in the classroom. C) The student's books' were left in the classroom. D) The students book's were left in the classroom.	A	Punctuation (Apostrophe for possession).

Section B: Lexis & Word Choice

No.	Question & Options	Ans	Diagnostic Focus
11	The soldier's _____ behavior during the battle earned him a medal. A) cowardly B) gallant C) passive D) erratic	B	Advanced Adjectives/Character traits.
12	Despite the economic downturn, the company's profits remained _____. A) stagnant B) soaring C) buoyant D) volatile	C	Business/Economic Lexis (Nigerian core).
13	She has a propensity for getting into trouble. The word in bold means: A) Habit B) Reason C) Dislike D) Fear	A	Synonyms: High-level academic lexis.
14	The opposite of ' Obscure ' is: A) Clear B) Dark C) Hidden D) Complicated	A	Antonyms/Clarity of thought.
15	The weather forecast says it will be a parched summer. This implies: A) Very wet B) Very hot and dry C) Extremely cold D) Windy	B	Environmental Lexis.
16	He is a man of his word; he never welches on a deal. This means he: A) Doesn't lie B) Doesn't fail to keep a promise C) Doesn't talk much D) Doesn't like money	B	Advanced Idiomatic Expressions.
17	Identify the odd one out: A) Metaphor B) Simile C) Onomatopoeia D) Paragraph	D	Literary Terms (Genre knowledge).
18	"The news was a bitter pill to swallow." This is an example of: A) Personification B) Metaphor C) Hyperbole D) Irony	B	Figures of Speech (IGCSE readiness).
19	Which word is spelled correctly? A) Accomodation B) Accommodation C) Acomodation D) Accommodatun	B	Common Spelling Pitfalls.
20	Which of these sounds is voiced? A) /p/ B) /k/ C) /b/ D) /t/	C	Oral English/Phonology (Cambridge/WAEC).
21	Diagnostic Insight: Failure in Q2 and Q5 indicates significant gaps in advanced syntax necessary for SS2 Cambridge English.	-	Syntactic complexity check.